CMSC701 Spring 2026: Wrap-up and FAQ

UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND

End of Semester FAQ

1. **When is the final?**
   - **Take-home. Released May 11, due May 13. (On grade scope)**

2. **What content will be on the final?**
   - **The final is comprehensive, it will cover content from throughout the semester. We covered much more material than can be put on the final, so content will be selective (*in general, likelihood a topic will appear is proportional to time we spent on it)*.**

3. **What will the format of the exam be?**
   - **Short answer / fill-in-the-blank & longer-form "thinking" and algorithm design questions**

5. **How can I prepare for the final?**
   - **Go over the lectures, go over your projects, google about material you still don't get.**

6. **What resources can I use for the final**
   - **Anything on the class website, gradescope, or piazza.**
   - **You may *not* use AI on the final, or refer to other web resources.**

7. **Course survey. (https://umd.bluera.com/umd/)**

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8. **Final course project (gradescope).**
    - **Due May 18 (11:59PM).**
    - **No extensions possible, no late penalty, submission will close at 11:59PM on the 18**
    - **Deliverables:**
        - **Report (~ 5 page, research style document)**
        - **I recommend (do not require) the OUP template (https://www.overleaf.com/latex/templates/oup-general-template/ybpypwncdxyb)**
        - **Any associated code (in a GitHub repository)**
    - **NOTES: You should write the report yourself (no AI authors).**

9. **Other questions?**

What we didn’t cover.

<u>Most</u> of bioinformatics and computational biology:

- much of “long read” technology and method development
- non-RNA single-cell genomics (e.g. single-cell ATAC-seq, CRISPR)
- metagenomics
- biological network analysis
- “systems” biology (e.g. regulatory inference)
- biostatistics and statistical interpretation of genomics results
- modern approaches of machine learning in bioinformatics (deep learning)
- much, much more.
- If you like this content consider taking CMSC702 with Prof. Erin Molloy in the Fall.
- If you’d like to explore these ideas further (& build new ones), my lab is recruiting PhD students.